

George Washington Carver (1864–1943)

A scientist and educator, Carver pioneered the use of crops, such as peanuts and soybeans, which were a valuable source of nutrition. He was the first African American to achieve recognition for his groundbreaking scientific achievements.

Willa Cather (1873–1947)

Cather moved to Nebraska from Virginia at the age of nine. The author later worked in New York City, but prairie life inspired her celebrated trilogy, *O Pioneers!*, *The Song of the Lark*, and *My Antonia*.

Lucy Maud Montgomery (1874–1942)

Montgomery was the author of *Anne of Green Gables* (1908), the first of eight novels about the orphan Anne Shirley. Set in the Canadian Maritimes, these books remain popular around the world.

Helen Keller (1880–1968)

Young Helen was blind and deaf and cut off from the world, until her teacher, Anne Sullivan, taught her sign language by touch when Helen was 16. Helen later graduated from college and became a writer and social activist.

Georgia O'Keefe (1887–1986)

O'Keefe is one of America's most celebrated artists, and one of the first female artists to achieve recognition for her work. She first became known for her large paintings of flowers. After moving to New Mexico in 1929, she painted many images inspired by the landscape and buildings around her.

Fredrick Banting (1891–1941)

As a young doctor, Dr. Banting studied the pancreas, and his work helped lead to the discovery of insulin, which is used by patients with diabetes. Banting's work has saved countless lives, and he shared the Nobel Prize in Medicine for his discovery in 1923.

Dorothea Lange (1895–1965)

During the Great Depression of the 1930s, photographer Lange became famous for taking black and white photographs of unemployed and homeless people. Her best-known work, "Migrant Mother," revealed a migrant worker's resilient strength.

Lester B. Pearson (1897–1972)

An experienced diplomat, Pearson was instrumental in resolving the Suez Crisis in 1956 by forming the first UN Peacekeeping force. He won the 1957 Nobel Peace Prize, and was prime minister of Canada from 1963–1968.

Duke Ellington (1899–1974)

Ellington was a musician and big band leader who was instrumental in raising the profile of jazz music. He was a contributor to New York City's Harlem Renaissance in the 1920s and 1930s.

Tommy Douglas (1904–1986)

Douglas was a prominent politician and socialist who rose to national attention as the premier of Saskatchewan, from 1944 to 1961. His most long-lasting achievement was introducing government-sponsored health care in Canada in 1962.

Marshall McLuhan (1911–1980)

An educator and philosopher, McLuhan studied the effect of evolving technologies and media on society. He created the expressions "the medium is the message" and "the global village" to help identify the changes he observed.

Jonas Salk (1914–1995)

A medical researcher specializing in virology, Salk developed an oral vaccine that protected people from polio. It was released in 1955. When asked who owned the patent, Salk modestly replied: "Could you patent the Sun?"

John A. Hopps (1919–1998)

Originally an electrical engineer, Hopps was doing medical research when he discovered that a stopped heart could be electrically shocked into starting again. He was part of a team that developed the first external pacemaker in 1951.

Gloria Steinem (1934–)

Steinem was a journalist and prominent leader of the American feminist movement of the 1960s. She co-founded *Ms. Magazine*, and has supported many political and social issues relating to women.

James Gosling (1955–)

Gosling invented the Java programming language in 1994 as a software developer for Sun Microsystems. Java can run on virtually any computer, regardless of the platform, and it is widely used for web applications and client-server communication.

Terry Fox (1958–1981)

After losing a leg to cancer in 1977, Fox began a cross-Canada run in 1980, using an artificial leg, to raise money for cancer research. He died before he could finish, but annual Terry Fox Runs are still held all over the world, raising millions of dollars for research.

Duke Ellington composed more than 2,000 pieces of music

